

Hitachi

We met the leaders of its AI strategy

Looking to leverage AI as a tailwind

During our Japan Big Tech tour, we had the opportunity to meet Atsushi Motoyama, Head of the AI CoE (AI Center of Excellence), and Jun Yoshida, Deputy Head. What left a particular impression about Hitachi's physical AI strategy was that (1) the market for its core maintenance business is vast and AI can enhance value added, (2) products with long production lead times that are complex and large scale are more likely to benefit from physical AI, (3) conglomerates with both IT and operational technology (OT) capabilities will hold an advantage in the AI era, (4) the company has decided to not develop AI models, and (5) pricing based on per-person billing rates is likely to break down in the IT services market, increasing the value added of forward deployed engineers (FDEs) that use AI.

Physical AI appears well suited to heavy industry

Its physical AI strategy is likely to be effective for products such as power transmission equipment, railway rolling stock, elevators and semiconductor production equipment (SPE), which contain large numbers of components and have production lead times exceeding six months. It can optimise complex manufacturing processes comprising numerous stages and predict likely failure timings by monitoring large numbers of components through sensors. From this perspective, it becomes easier to understand why the company divested businesses such as automobiles, white goods and construction machinery.

Diversified electrical businesses a positive factor

Management emphasised that Hitachi's strength lies in having both IT services and heavy industry businesses within the group. Implementation is likely to become increasingly important in AI adoption. Few companies globally possess both operational business expertise and IT implementation capabilities. For example, some companies may understand AI models but lack knowledge of real-world business applications. Conversely, most companies that understand business applications may not understand AI well. The same applies at the individual employee level within the company, but because the needed talent exists internally, synergies are more readily generated through AI implementation. In fact, requests for collaboration from business divisions to the IT services business are apparently increasing.

Valuation: Still recommend Hitachi as our top pick in diversified electricals

Our price target of ¥7,100 is based on a FY3/28E EV/EBITDA multiple of 14X. We believe profit growth in the power grid business will drive the share price in the near term.

Equities

Japan
Advanced Industrial Equipment

12-month rating **Buy**

12m price target **¥7,100**

Price (01 Oct 2026) **¥5,510**

RIC: 6501.T BBG: 6501 JP

Trading data and key metrics

52-wk range	¥5,818-3,900
Market cap.	¥24,635b/US\$156b
Shares o/s	4,471m (ORD)
Free float	60%
Avg. daily volume ('000)	11,284
Avg. daily value (m)	¥58,864.9
Common s/h equity (03/27E)	¥6756b
P/BV (03/27E)	3.6x
Net debt to EBITDA (03/27E)	0.1x

EPS (reported, basic) (JPY)

	UBS	Cons.
03/27E	232.2	220.1
03/28E	263.7	264.5
03/29E	297.5	306.9

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Highlights (¥b)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Revenues	9,728.7	9,783.4	10,586.8	11,820.0	12,660.0	13,700.0	14,760.0	15,920.0
Operating profit	755.8	971.6	1,199.3	1,500.0	1,675.0	1,850.0	1,995.0	2,140.0
Pre-tax profit	825.8	962.7	1,273.1	1,510.0	1,685.0	1,860.0	2,005.0	2,150.0
Net profit (reported)	589.9	615.7	802.4	1,013.0	1,130.5	1,253.0	1,354.5	1,456.0
EPS (reported, basic) (¥)	127.3	134.5	178.3	232.2	263.7	297.5	327.4	358.4
Profitability/valuation	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
EBIT (UBS) margin %	7.8	9.9	11.3	12.7	13.2	13.5	13.5	13.4
ROIC (EBIT) %	11.8	17.0	20.8	24.5	25.1	25.8	25.9	25.9
EV/EBITDA (UBS core) x	8.4	11.7	11.9	12.3	11.3	10.4	9.7	9.1
P/E (reported, basic) x	15.4	26.6	24.8	23.7	20.9	18.5	16.8	15.4
Dividend yield (net) %	1.8	1.2	1.1	1.1	1.3	1.5	1.6	1.6

Source: Company accounts, LSEG Eikon, UBS estimates. Metrics marked as (UBS) have had analyst adjustments applied. Valuations: based on an average share price that year, (E): based on a share price of ¥ 5,510 on 01-Oct-2026 17:04:15 JST

Hitachi (6501.T)

Income Statement (¥b)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	%ch	03/28E	%ch	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Revenues	9,728.7	9,783.4	10,586.8	11,820.0	11.6	12,660.0	7.1	13,700.0	14,760.0	15,920.0
Gross profit	2,582.1	2,820.8	3,179.5	3,500.0	10.1	3,775.0	7.9	4,050.0	4,295.0	4,540.0
EBITDA (UBS)	1,207.3	1,403.0	1,657.2	1,956.0	18.0	2,151.0	10.0	2,336.0	2,481.0	2,626.0
Depreciation & amortisation	(451.5)	(431.4)	(457.9)	(456.0)	0.4	(476.0)	-4.4	(486.0)	(486.0)	(486.0)
EBIT (UBS)	755.8	971.6	1,199.3	1,500.0	25.1	1,675.0	11.7	1,850.0	1,995.0	2,140.0
Associates & investment income	102.1	6.0	74.8	10.0	-86.6	10.0	0.0	10.0	10.0	10.0
Other non-operating income	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Net interest	(32.1)	(14.9)	(0.9)	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Exceptionals (incl goodwill)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Pre-tax profit	825.8	962.7	1,273.1	1,510.0	18.6	1,685.0	11.6	1,860.0	2,005.0	2,150.0
Tax	(199.1)	(305.9)	(421.7)	(447.0)	-6.0	(499.5)	-11.7	(552.0)	(595.5)	(639.0)
Profit after tax	626.7	656.9	851.4	1,063.0	24.8	1,185.5	11.5	1,308.0	1,409.5	1,511.0
Preference dividends	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Minorities	(36.9)	(41.1)	(49.1)	(50.0)	-1.9	(55.0)	-10.0	(55.0)	(55.0)	(55.0)
Extraordinary items	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Net profit (reported)	589.9	615.7	802.4	1,013.0	26.3	1,130.5	11.6	1,253.0	1,354.5	1,456.0
Net earnings (UBS)	589.9	615.7	802.4	1,013.0	26.3	1,130.5	11.6	1,253.0	1,354.5	1,456.0
Tax rate (%)	24.1	31.8	33.1	29.6	-10.6	29.6	0.1	29.7	29.7	29.7
Per Share (¥)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	%ch	03/28E	%ch	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
EPS (UBS, diluted)	127.3	134.5	178.3	232.2	30.2	263.7	13.6	297.5	327.4	358.4
EPS (local GAAP, diluted)	127.3	134.5	178.3	232.2	30.2	263.7	13.6	297.5	327.4	358.4
EPS (UBS, basic)	127.3	134.5	178.3	232.2	30.2	263.7	13.6	297.5	327.4	358.4
DPS (net) (¥)	36.0	43.0	50.0	63.0	26.0	70.0	11.1	80.0	88.0	88.0
Cash EPS (UBS, diluted) ¹	224.8	228.7	280.1	336.8	20.2	374.7	11.3	412.8	444.9	478.1
Book value per share	1,231.1	1,277.3	1,459.7	1,548.9	6.1	1,699.7	9.7	1,876.2	2,077.1	2,312.0
Average shares (diluted)	4,633.1	4,577.9	4,499.8	4,362.3	-3.1	4,287.3	-1.7	4,212.3	4,137.3	4,062.3
Balance Sheet (¥b)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	%ch	03/28E	%ch	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Cash and equivalents	705.4	866.2	1,323.5	875.4	-33.9	943.5	7.8	1,028.5	1,179.7	1,399.6
Other current assets	5,149.2	5,731.6	6,543.8	7,228.4	10.5	7,681.3	6.3	8,257.5	8,853.3	9,510.8
Total current assets	5,854.6	6,597.8	7,867.2	8,103.8	3.0	8,624.7	6.4	9,286.1	10,033.0	10,910.4
Net tangible fixed assets	1,221.8	1,341.5	1,652.9	1,909.9	15.5	2,146.9	12.4	2,373.9	2,600.9	2,827.9
Net intangible fixed assets	3,550.4	3,686.8	3,863.2	3,762.2	-2.6	3,661.2	-2.7	3,560.2	3,459.2	3,358.2
Investments / other assets	1,594.4	1,658.6	1,657.9	1,657.9	0.0	1,657.9	0.0	1,657.9	1,657.9	1,657.9
Total assets	12,221.3	13,284.8	15,041.2	15,433.8	2.6	16,090.7	4.3	16,878.1	17,751.0	18,754.4
Trade payables & other ST liabilities	4,311.0	5,185.7	6,380.5	6,584.9	3.2	6,711.4	1.9	6,882.7	7,065.3	7,270.2
Short term debt	225.3	442.0	469.3	469.3	0.0	469.3	0.0	469.3	469.3	469.3
Total current liabilities	4,536.4	5,627.6	6,849.8	7,054.2	3.0	7,180.7	1.8	7,352.0	7,534.5	7,739.4
Long term debt	954.7	764.2	539.8	539.8	0.0	539.8	0.0	539.8	539.8	539.8
Other long term liabilities	870.6	861.6	879.1	879.1	0.0	879.1	0.0	879.1	879.1	879.1
Preferred shares	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Total liabilities (incl pref shares)	6,361.7	7,253.4	8,268.6	8,473.0	2.5	8,599.6	1.5	8,770.9	8,953.4	9,158.3
Common s/h equity	5,703.7	5,847.1	6,568.4	6,756.5	2.9	7,286.9	7.9	7,903.0	8,593.4	9,391.9
Minority interests	155.9	184.3	204.2	204.2	0.0	204.2	0.0	204.2	204.2	204.2
Total liabilities & equity	12,221.3	13,284.8	15,041.2	15,433.8	2.6	16,090.7	4.3	16,878.1	17,751.0	18,754.4
Cash Flow (¥b)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	%ch	03/28E	%ch	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Net income (before pref divs)	589.9	615.7	802.4	1,013.0	26.3	1,130.5	11.6	1,253.0	1,354.5	1,456.0
Depreciation & amortisation	451.5	431.4	457.9	456.0	-0.4	476.0	4.4	486.0	486.0	486.0
Net change in working capital	1,101.2	292.2	382.7	(480.3)	-	(326.3)	32.1	(405.0)	(413.3)	(452.6)
Other operating	(1,186.0)	(167.1)	25.1	(20.0)	-	(20.0)	0.0	(20.0)	(20.0)	(20.0)
Operating cash flow	956.6	1,172.3	1,668.1	968.7	-41.9	1,260.2	30.1	1,314.0	1,407.2	1,469.4
Tangible capital expenditure	(315.8)	(351.8)	(473.9)	(511.0)	-7.8	(511.0)	0.0	(511.0)	(511.0)	(511.0)
Intangible capital expenditure	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Net (acquisitions) & disposals	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other investing	184.3	(221.9)	132.3	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Investing cash flow	(131.5)	(573.7)	(341.6)	(511.0)	-49.6	(511.0)	0.0	(511.0)	(511.0)	(511.0)
Equity dividends paid	(166.8)	(196.8)	(225.0)	(274.8)	-22.1	(300.1)	-9.2	(337.0)	(364.1)	(357.5)
Share issues / (buybacks)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other financing	247.2	(267.0)	(447.2)	(631.0)	-41.1	(381.0)	39.6	(381.0)	(381.0)	(381.0)
Change in debt & pref shares	(1,033.3)	26.1	(197.1)	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Financing cash flow	(953.0)	(437.7)	(869.3)	(905.8)	-4.2	(681.1)	24.8	(718.0)	(745.1)	(738.5)
Cash flow inc/(dec) in cash	(127.9)	160.9	457.2	(448.1)	-	68.1	-	85.1	151.1	219.9
FX / non cash items	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Balance sheet inc/(dec) in cash	(127.9)	160.9	457.2	(448.1)	-	68.1	-	85.1	151.1	219.9

Source: Company accounts, UBS estimates. (UBS) metrics use reported figures which have been adjusted by UBS analysts. ¹ Cash EPS (UBS, diluted) is calculated using UBS net income adding back depreciation and amortization.

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Valuation (x)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
P/E (local GAAP, diluted)	15.4	26.6	24.8	23.7	20.9	18.5	16.8	15.4
P/E (UBS, diluted)	15.4	26.6	24.8	23.7	20.9	18.5	16.8	15.4
P/CEPS	8.7	15.7	15.8	16.4	14.7	13.3	12.4	11.5
Equity FCF (UBS) yield %	7.0	5.0	5.9	1.9	3.0	3.3	3.6	3.9
Dividend yield (net) %	1.8	1.2	1.1	1.1	1.3	1.5	1.6	1.6
P/BV	1.6	2.8	3.0	3.6	3.2	2.9	2.7	2.4
EV/revenues (core)	1.0	1.7	1.9	2.0	1.9	1.8	1.6	1.5
EV/EBITDA (UBS core)	8.4	11.7	11.9	12.3	11.3	10.4	9.7	9.1
EV/EBIT (core)	13.4	16.9	16.4	16.1	14.5	13.1	12.1	11.2
EV/OpFCF (core)	9.2	12.8	13.1	13.5	12.3	11.2	10.4	9.7
EV/op. invested capital	1.6	2.9	3.4	3.9	3.6	3.4	3.1	2.9
Enterprise value (¥b)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Market cap.	9,111.3	16,503.8	20,121.5	24,635.3	24,635.3	24,635.3	24,635.3	24,635.3
Net debt (cash)	1,340.9	407.3	12.7	(90.4)	99.6	23.0	(95.1)	(280.6)
Buy out of minorities	274.3	170.1	194.3	204.2	204.2	204.2	204.2	204.2
Pension provisions/other	549.7	520.1	540.4	553.0	553.0	553.0	553.0	553.0
Total enterprise value	11,276.2	17,601.3	20,868.9	25,302.1	25,492.1	25,415.5	25,297.4	25,111.9
Non core assets	(1,136.5)	(1,185.8)	(1,205.7)	(1,205.7)	(1,205.7)	(1,205.7)	(1,205.7)	(1,205.7)
Core enterprise value	10,139.7	16,415.5	19,663.2	24,096.4	24,286.4	24,209.8	24,091.7	23,906.2
Growth (%)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Revenue	(10.6)	0.6	8.2	11.6	7.1	8.2	7.7	7.9
EBITDA (UBS)	(5.3)	16.2	18.1	18.0	10.0	8.6	6.2	5.8
EBIT (UBS)	1.0	28.6	23.4	25.1	11.7	10.4	7.8	7.3
EPS (UBS, diluted)	(8.4)	5.6	32.6	30.2	13.6	12.8	10.1	9.5
Net DPS	33.3	19.4	16.3	26.0	11.1	14.3	10.0	0.0
Margins & Profitability (%)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Gross profit margin	26.5	28.8	30.0	29.6	29.8	29.6	29.1	28.5
EBITDA margin	12.4	14.3	15.7	16.5	17.0	17.1	16.8	16.5
EBIT (UBS) margin	7.8	9.9	11.3	12.7	13.2	13.5	13.5	13.4
Net earnings (UBS) margin	6.1	6.3	7.6	8.6	8.9	9.1	9.2	9.1
ROIC (EBIT)	11.8	17.0	20.8	24.5	25.1	25.8	25.9	25.9
ROIC post tax	8.6	11.8	14.0	17.3	17.7	18.2	18.2	18.2
ROE (UBS)	11.1	10.7	12.9	15.2	16.1	16.5	16.4	16.2
Capital structure & Coverage (x)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Net debt / EBITDA	0.4	0.2	(0.2)	0.1	0.0	0.0	(0.1)	(0.1)
Net debt / total equity %	8.1	5.6	(4.6)	1.9	0.9	(0.2)	(1.9)	(4.1)
Net debt / (net debt + total equity) %	7.5	5.3	(4.9)	1.9	0.9	(0.2)	(2.0)	(4.2)
Net debt/EV %	11.9	2.3	0.1	(0.4)	0.4	0.1	(0.4)	(1.1)
Capex / depreciation %	112.7	147.4	188.7	NM	186.5	179.9	179.9	179.9
Capex / revenue %	3.2	3.6	4.5	4.3	4.0	3.7	3.5	3.2
EBIT / net interest	26.7	65.7	NM	-	-	-	-	-
Dividend cover (UBS)	3.5	3.1	3.6	3.7	3.8	3.7	3.7	4.1
Div. payout ratio (UBS) %	28.3	32.0	28.0	27.1	26.5	26.9	26.9	24.6
Revenues by division (¥b)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Green	3,052.3	3,915.5	3,220.0	4,120.0	4,720.0	5,420.0	6,220.0	7,120.0
Connective	3,058.0	3,163.2	3,262.8	3,320.0	3,460.0	3,600.0	3,660.0	3,720.0
Digital	2,598.7	2,832.6	2,940.1	3,200.0	3,300.0	3,400.0	3,500.0	3,600.0
Others	507.8	497.5	531.1	530.0	530.0	530.0	530.0	530.0
Others	511.9	(625.4)	632.8	650.0	650.0	750.0	850.0	950.0
Total	9,728.7	9,783.4	10,586.8	11,820.0	12,660.0	13,700.0	14,760.0	15,920.0
EBIT (UBS) by division (¥b)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Green	128.3	273.8	366.6	525.0	625.0	725.0	825.0	925.0
Digital	310.8	374.7	430.0	510.0	530.0	550.0	570.0	590.0
Connective	290.0	325.8	354.5	375.0	420.0	475.0	500.0	525.0
Others	6.2	11.9	22.9	20.0	20.0	20.0	20.0	20.0
Elimination	(27.9)	(14.7)	(53.1)	(30.0)	(30.0)	(30.0)	(30.0)	(30.0)
Others	48.4	0.1	78.4	100.0	110.0	110.0	110.0	110.0
Total	755.8	971.6	1,199.3	1,500.0	1,675.0	1,850.0	1,995.0	2,140.0

Source: Company accounts, UBS estimates. (UBS) metrics use reported figures which have been adjusted by UBS analysts.

Forecast returns

Forecast price appreciation	28.9%
Forecast dividend yield	1.2%
Forecast stock return	30.0%
Market return assumption	8.1%
Forecast excess return	22.0%

Company Description

Hitachi has a big presence in many fields. Its earnings pillars are IT services, elevators, industrial infrastructure, automobiles, and railways. The firm is concentrating its management resources around social innovation (social infrastructure and IT services) from which it is aiming to derive more than 10% of OP globally.

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

We value the shares based on EV/EBITDA. Risks include 1) a global macroeconomic slowdown, 2) a sudden stagnation in electric power demand, particularly for AI, and 3) slowing growth in GlobalLogic and domestic IT services businesses.

Quantitative Research Review

UBS Global Research publishes a quantitative assessment of its analysts' responses to certain questions about the likelihood of an occurrence of a number of short term factors in a product known as the 'Quantitative Research Review'. The views for this month can be found below. Views contained in this assessment on a particular stock reflect only the views on those short term factors which are a different timeframe to the 12-month timeframe reflected in any equity rating set out in this note. For previous responses please make reference to (i) previous UBS Global Research reports; and (ii) where no applicable research report was published that month, the Quantitative Research Review which can be found at <https://neo.ubs.com/quantitative>, or contact your UBS sales representative for access to the report or the Quantitative Research Team on ubs-quant-answers@ubs.com. A consolidated report which contains all responses is also available and again you should contact your UBS sales representative for details and pricing or the Quantitative Research Team on the email above.

Hitachi

Question	Response
1. Is the industry structure facing the firm likely to improve or deteriorate over the next six months? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting worse, 3 = no change, 5 = getting better, N/A = no view)	2
2. Is the regulatory/government environment facing the firm likely to improve or deteriorate over the next six months? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting tougher, 3 = no change, 5 = getting better, N/A = no view)	4
3. Over the last 3-6 months in broad terms have things been improving/no change/getting worse for this stock? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting a lot worse, 3 = not much change, 5 = getting a lot better, N/A = no view)	3
4. Relative to the current CONSENSUS EPS forecast, is the next company EPS update likely to lead to: (1 = negative surprise vs consensus, 3 = in-line with consensus, 5 = positive surprise vs consensus expectations, N/A = no view)	3
5. What's driving the difference?	
6. Relative to YOUR current earnings forecast, is there relatively greater risk at the next earnings result of: (1 = downside skew risk to earnings, 3 = equal upside or downside risk to earnings, 5 = upside skew risk to earnings, N/A = no view)	3
7. What's driving the difference?	
8. Is there an upcoming catalyst for the company over the next three months?	No Catalyst
9. Is there an actual or approximate date for the catalyst?	
10. Is the catalyst date an actual or approximate date?	
11. What is the catalyst?	

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12-Month Rating	Definition	Coverage ¹	IB Services ²
Buy	FSR is > 6% above the MRA.	55%	24%
Neutral	FSR is between -6% and 6% of the MRA.	40%	21%
Sell	FSR is > 6% below the MRA.	6%	21%

Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 30 June 2026.

1:Percentage of companies under coverage globally within the 12-month rating category.

2:Percentage of companies within the 12-month rating category for which investment banking (IB) services were provided within the past 12 months.

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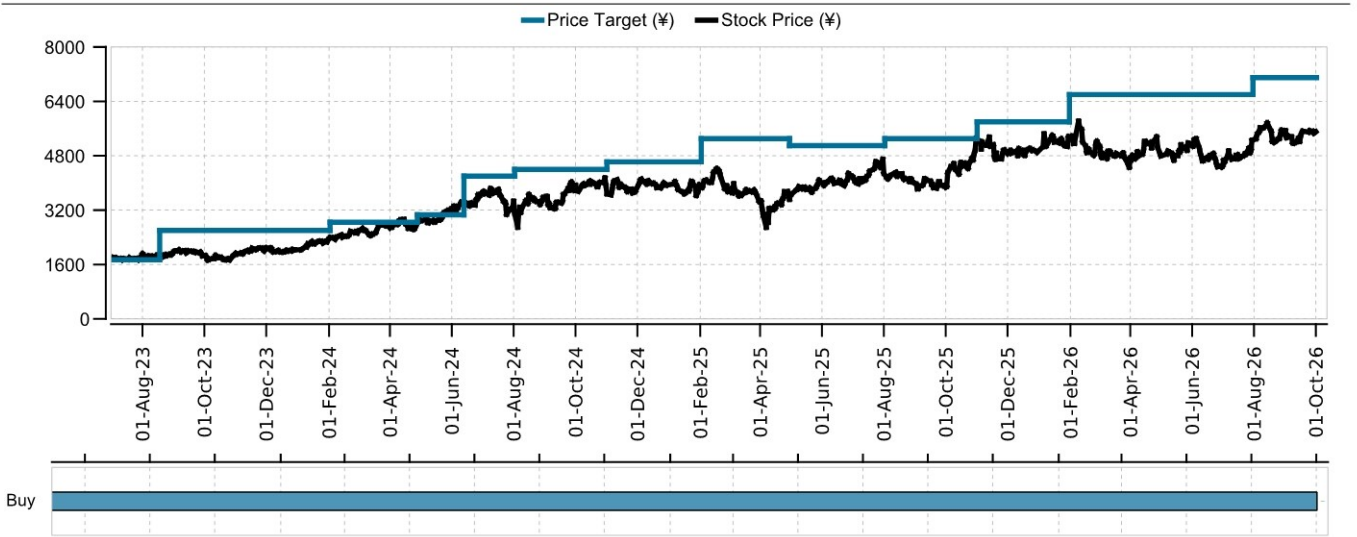
Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
Hitachi ²⁸	6501.T	Buy	¥5,510	01 Oct 2026

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon. All prices as of local market close. Ratings in this table are the most current published ratings prior to this report. They may be more recent than the stock pricing date.

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Hitachi (¥)



Date	Stock Price (¥)	Price Target (¥)	Rating
2023-06-30	1779	1740	Buy
2023-08-17	1841	2600	Buy
2024-02-01	2357	2840	Buy
2024-04-27	2695	3060	Buy
2024-06-12	3408	4200	Buy
2024-08-01	3463	4400	Buy
2024-10-31	3924	4620	Buy
2025-02-01	3946	5300	Buy
2025-04-29	3747	5100	Buy
2025-08-01	4283	5300	Buy
2025-10-31	5318	5800	Buy
2026-01-30	5361	6600	Buy
2026-07-30	5255	7100	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 01-Oct-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

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